the 25th, more than 100 people had been detained, including leaders of the NLD and other leaders of civil society organizations. The state-controlled media began to publicize the detentions, claiming that the agitators were attempting to undermine peace and security within Myanmar. The state also claimed that this was an attempt to destabilize the ongoing national convention process.

Almost immediately protesters were harassed and threatened by the pro-government Union Solidarity Development Association (USDA) and other militias that were armed by government agents. By August 22, armed police, who assisted the USDA members in assaulting the civilians, interrupted additional protests. The police later arrested protesters following clashes with the USDA contingent.

A key turning point for the Saffron Revolution occurred on August 28 when monks in Sittwe (located in the Arakan state) took to the streets. On the same day, labor organizers led by Su Su Nway marched in Rangoon chanting for lower fuel and commodity prices. The regime's reprisals became increasingly violent in early September. The fact that the government was in the process of announcing the completion of the 14-year-long national convention in early September may have played into the decision to crackdown in such an aggressive fashion.

Another turning point in the Saffron Revolution occurred on September 5. The religious center of Pakokku, situated close to Mandalay, became a center of protest for the monks. The monks denounced the previous price hikes and were able to gain significant momentum from area residents. The decision by the monks to join the protests was deeply significant because of the unique moral standing that is placed on the sangha. Furthermore, since colonial times monks have been at the center of political uprisings in Burma.

The military launched into a brutal crackdown against the monks at this time. Monks were tied to lampposts and brutally beaten. Dozens of monks and bystanders were apprehended and imprisoned. Furthermore, it was rumored that one monk died as a result of the violence. This abuse of the monks created significant backlash against the regime. Protests spread and the anger against the regime reached a breaking point. The following day a government delegation was sent to the monastery to seek forgiveness for